

JUNCTION 2026

PARTICIPANT GUIDEBOOK

Junction 2026

European Tech Renaissance

13–15 November 2026 • Hype Areena, Espoo

WIFI
Junction2026

PASSWORD
pushtheboundaries

EVENT PLATFORM
hackjunction.app

DISCORD
discord.gg/NMDxBZEep

VENUE
Vanha Jorvaksentie 3
02320 Espoo

QUESTIONS
hello@hackjunction.com

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Hey there! Welcome Onboard 👋

This year's theme, **European Tech Renaissance**, invites you to explore the intersection of idealism and caution in shaping tomorrow's technology and society.

As always, Junction 2026 promises a weekend filled with with workshops, mentorship, and plenty of space for creativity. This is your chance to meet new people, tackle real challenges, and turn bold ideas into something exciting, all in an atmosphere that's as fun as it is inspiring.

We're excited to have you joining us on the 11 year anniversary of Junction!

☑️ IMPORTANT THINGS

1. Make sure you have joined our Discord Server: HERE This is where all the event-related communication before, during, and after the event will be happening. You can also get to know fellow hackers there and even start looking for team members!

2. Fill information in your **Junction Platform Profile** if you are interested in recruitment. Our Partner companies will be checking it out.

3. **The registration has to be done individually. You must keep the badge visible at all times.**

01 General

💡 FAQs

Q What is a Hackathon?

Hackathon is a state of mind.

A hackathon is a fast-paced event, where participants team up to create solutions and concepts from scratch in a short amount of time, addressing current problems. There are hackathons of various lengths and types, but one common characteristic of them is that they are centered around a specific theme. This year's theme is European Tech Renaissance.

Usually, the teams that perform the best in hackathons are the ones with the most diverse set of members, ranging from techies and programmers to business and design enthusiasts. The most feasible prototypes are not only well functioning, but also well designed with a working business model.

Q What is Junction?

Junction is a global tech community, organizing hackathons and tech events around the year and around the world offline and online. Junction 2026 is our flagship event - Europe's leading hackathon, organized for the 11th time this year!

Q What is happening at the Junction 2026 event?

Junction 2026 is a weekend-long hackathon, where participants team up and create tech projects to the challenges set by our partner companies. The projects can range from physical prototypes to new games, software and concepts. With their projects, participants also compete for winning prizes on a challenge, as well as the Main Prize of 10 000 EUR. The total prize pool of the event is 100 000 EUR.

Q Do I need a team to attend?

Attending without a team is also possible! However, you can check the Junction Discord channel to find team members.

Q Does it cost to attend?

Nope! Moreover, we provide drinks & snacks.

Q Who are the people behind Junction?

Junction is run by a team of 8 full-timers and hundreds of volunteers, all passionate about organizing the best hackathons in the world!

Q How are the winners chosen?

The winners of the challenge tracks are chosen by the companies providing the challenges. The finalists of Junction 2026 will be chosen with a peer-review system. The top projects will be pitched live for judges on stage on Sunday (15th).

Q Can I claim the badge to a team member?

No, everyone has to claim their badges individually at the registration.

🧭 Packing List

Here's a list things that you should at least bring with you to the event:

- Valid ID card
- Tech stuff: Laptop, charger, headphones, and adapter if you travel from outside the EU
- Change of clothes
- Toiletries and a towel
- Water bottle - As a part of the event sustainability plan we only supply tap water instead of bottled water and **no disposable** water cups will be provided. Please bring your own water bottle with you, so that you can refill it from a tap at the venue.

📶 **Wi-Fi will be provided**

✖️ We **do not** provide:

- screens
- internet cables
- computer mouses
- headphones
- keyboards

NOTE: We kindly ask you **not to take** any luggage to the event area because the space is limited.

📍 Location and the venue

This year the main event will take place at Hype Arena**.**

Address: Vanha Jorvaksentie 3, 02320 Espoo

You can be at the venue 24/7 but sleeping there is ***legally not allowed***.

WiFi name: Junction2026
Password: pushtheboundaries

Maps

The maps for each floor of Hype Areena used during the event can be found in the Venue Map section below.

📌 Registrations

Every participant has to register before entering the venue. The registration has to be done individually. You can't claim the badge for a team member.

Prepare to show a valid ID card and the QR code found on your Junction Dashboard. You will get your QR code after **CONFIRMING** your participation.

After checking in, you'll receive a badge, which is needed to enter the event area at all times. NOTE: **The badge must be visible at all times.**

The check-in at the venue starts on **Friday (13th) at 16:00** and is located on the 2nd floor.

The registration team will be available until **Friday (13th) at 23.59** in the event info at 3rd floor.

🗓️ Schedule for Hackers

Friday	13.11
16:00	Doors open & registration (2nd floor)
18:00–19:30	Opening ceremony
18:05–18:20	Opening words
18:20–18:30	Practicalities
18:30–19:10	Keynote by Google DeepMind
19:10–19:30	Challenge videos
19:30	Hacking starts!
19:30	Dinner served
20:00–20:30	Workshop by Google DeepMind (Loft, 4th floor)
20:30–21:00	Workshop by Verda (Loft, 4th floor)
20:30–21:00	Workshop by Arduino (Arduino Hardware Lab, 5th floor)
21:00–21:30	Workshop by MLH x GitHub (location to be announced)
23:59	**Pre-submission**

Saturday	14.11
11:00–11:30	Workshop by Cala (Loft, 4th floor)
12:00	Submissions open
12:00–12:30	Workshop by Intel (Hardware Lab, 5th floor)
13:00	Lunch served
13:00–13:45	Keynote by Hostinger (Päälava)
13:30–14:00	Workshop by Modal (Loft, 4th floor)
14:30–15:15	Workshop by Kiuas (Loft, 4th floor)
16:30–17:00	Workshop by Exa (Loft, 4th floor)
17:30–18:00	Workshop by Context.dev (Loft, 4th floor)
18:00–18:30	Workshop by Maria01 (Loft, 4th floor)
18:00	Dinner served

Sunday	15.11
10:00	**Final Submission**
10:30–14:00	Peer reviewing the projects
14:00–16:05	Final Ceremony
14:05–14:10	Keynote by Arduino
14:10–14:15	Keynote by Verda
14:15–15:10	Top 5 Pitching
15:10–15:50	Challenge winners announced
15:50–16:05	Junction winner announced
17:00	Event ends
18:00	Doors close

Deadline · Main stage · Keynote · Workshop · Food

🗺️ Venue Map

TO BE UPDATED

🚇 Transportation

The venue will be open from **Friday 13th November 16:00** (4:00pm) until **Sunday 15th November 18:00** (6:00pm). You can enter and leave the event venue as you wish during the event.

However, note that sleeping at the venue is legally **not allowed**.

Public Transport 🚇

Metro: Kivenlahti (500 m)

Bus: Line 510 (stop Alakaupunki) (150 m) & Line 544 (stop Alakaupunki) (200 m)

Helsinki metropolitan area public transportation is arranged by HSL. You can find schedules, route information and more from HSL.

Public transportation journeys can be paid inside transportation vehicles by contactless payment with credit/debit card.

Public transportation tickets can be purchased from ticket machines at the transport stations and at the airport by the train station. There are also multiple places to purchase tickets, e.g. all R-Kioski shops.

The most common option for a resident is using the HSL App to buy tickets and plan your journeys.

Remember to purchase tickets before boarding. If you do not have a valid ticket, you are charged a penalty fare of 100 euros and the price of a single ticket.

Overall, public transportation in Helsinki area is very reliable and mostly on time. Do notice that the metro stops running around midnight. During the night you can grab a night bus or a taxi. Taxis in Finland are a reliable option, although a little bit more expensive.

Car 🚗

Arriving by car is not recommended, however there's a parking lot close by.

- Parking hall P-Kivenlahti is next to the venue: 1€/hour, 10€/day
  - More info: P-Kivenlahti, EuroPark

NOTE: Any additional fees from the parking have to be covered individually.

Taxi 🚕

Multiple taxi services are available in the Helsinki region as apps or some by phone.

- Taksi Kovanen (p. +358 200 6060)
- Bolt
- Uber
- FixuTaxi (p. +358 100 6060)
- Menevä (p. +358 800 02120)

The services vary in price and availability so the best option might be to create a user to a couple of them and compare pricing and availability.

🇫🇮 About Finland

Water 💧

As a part of the event sustainability plan we only supply tap water instead of bottled water. Finland's tap water is among the highest quality in the world and completely safe to drink. Please bring your own water bottle with you, so that you can refill it with pure and refreshing water from any tap at the venue. Again, welcome to Finland – drinks are on the house!

Weather ❄️

The weather in Finland can be very cold during November so remember to pack warm clothes with you!

Payments 💶

The currency in Finland is Euro. However, there is very rarely need to use cash, as it is very rare for a seller not to accept a card.

You can withdraw cash from Otto ATMs and Nosto ATMs, which are located sparsely in the Helsinki Metropolitan area.

Visiting Helsinki Metropolitan Area 🇫🇮

More information on Helsinki & Espoo

✅ Summary

Here is a one pager checklist to make your Junction 2026 experience the best it can be!

Before the event:

- Join the Discord channel and follow the updates by checking your email and our social media.
- Make sure to pack your valid ID card and laptop with additional equipment.
- If you don't have a team, you have three options: use the match-making on Junction Platform, head to #teambuilding Discord channel, or participate in the team building right after the opening show at the venue.
- Take a look at the tracks and challenges before arriving to have a general idea of what you want to work on during the weekend during the event.
- During the event there is additional program and chances to network with partners.
- The submission deadline is at 10am on Sunday.
- The peer and partner reviewing will be done immediately after the submission deadline.
- The event winner is selected with peer-evaluation and judges.
- The challenge winners are selected by the challenge partners.



👥 How to Build a Team

The team size can be 1-4 people

If you'd like to start looking for a team **before the event** (which we strongly recommend), we have a team-building tool on Junction Platform and a team-building channel in Discord.

Here's how it works:

Junction Platform: Team building

All team-related actions are happening on the Junction Platform. Open the Junction 2026 event on your profile's dashboard and click the "Team" tab from the left bar.

1. **If you already have a team:** Head to the Junction 2026 event on your profile's dashboard in **Junction Platform** and open the "Team" tab from the left bar. In case one of your team members has already created a team on Junction Platform, join it with a team code that your team member can send to you. In case you're the first one, you can create the team and share the code with your team members.
2. **If you don't have a team or you are lacking team members:** Use Team Management to find a team or post open positions for your team there. Send either an open application or apply to a specific role by clicking the apply button. You can accept or decline applications in the "team candidates" tab.

Discord: Team Building channel

1. Join the #teambuilding channel.
2. Check the previous posts and see if someone's already looking for a team member with your skill set. Contact them asking to join.
3. If you can't find a suitable team to join, you can post a short introduction about yourself, your skills, and what challenges you are interested in.
4. See someone who looks like a great match? Reach out to them and see if you would be a good team!
5. Once you find a team delete your message from the channel
6. Form a team in the Junction Platform

Discord Link

Team building at the beginning of the event

Arriving at the event without a team? Don't worry, because we will also have team building at the venue during Friday.

We recommend you think about the following aspects beforehand, since they can help you find the right team:

- Skills

- What motivates you
- Challenges you are most interested in

🔮 Challenges

What are the challenges? Where to find them?

Every year we provide different challenges to choose from at the main event. We'll update the challenge information on the Junction Platform **closer to the event**.

On Friday (13th November) at **23:59** o'clock you are asked to submit which challenge you are planning to tackle. You are allowed to change/submit a different challenge than the challenge you chose.

You are allowed to submit a project for **multiple challenges**.

Platforms Used

During Junction 2026 two key platforms are used: **Junction Platform** and **Discord**.

JUNCTION PLATFORM

The hackathon platform for forming teams, booking meetings with partners, submitting projects, and eventually reviewing them to decide on the winners! You already registered for this event on the Junction Platform.

DISCORD

The virtual platform, where you interact with other hackers, mentors, and organizers. Interaction happens through different channels. You'll find mentors from the challenge-specific channels and help from the organizers' channel. You'll also stay up to date on Discord through the announcements and watching the opening & closing ceremonies.

Discord Link

EMAIL

hello@hackjunction.com

We don't ever want to spam you, but please keep an eye on your inbox before, during and shortly after the event.

If you have any questions, it is also an email address to send them to!

🗳️ Reviewing

Evaluation criteria

INNOVATION

- Is the idea/concept/prototype new or different compared to the already presented ones?
- Does the idea/concept/prototype or some parts of it distinguish somehow from the already presented ones?

IMPACT

- Does the idea/concept/prototype have a significant impact on society through solving the problem(s) it addresses?
- Does the idea/concept/prototype have a significant impact on the majority of the people facing the problem it solves - how large is the ratio between the number of people whose problem got solved compared to the total people affected by the problem?

IMPLEMENTATION

- Is the idea/concept/prototype eventually realistic, viable and feasible to be implemented from all perspectives?

After submitting the projects, partner and peer reviewing will start in parallel. **All hackers need to be present at the venue for the live peer reviewing on Sunday (15th), 10:30–14:00.**

To ensure quality results, each participant should review the projects assigned to them. In case the team pitching are not at their assigned table, you will have the opportunity to press the "not present" button. **If you or your team do not take part in the peer reviewing, you are not eligible for the main prize.**

Partners select the challenge winners and runner-ups.

The overall TOP 5 projects are determined based on the peer reviewing. TOP teams are instructed for the pitches in the closing ceremony for 3 **minutes** each and afterwards there will be 3 **minutes for questions**, then **our panel of 7 judges vote on the best projects**

📥 Project Submission

The final submission deadline is on **Sunday the 15th at 10:00.**

The submission form closes automatically, and unfortunately we won't accept any late submissions.

Set your project to FINAL from DRAFT before the final deadline. Draft projects are not reviewed. You can edit the submissions at any time before the deadline, even the final projects.

- **NOTE: The top teams will be contacted regarding the pitching before the Closing Ceremony.**

For the final submission we require:

- Project name, punchline, description
- Challenge
- Technologies used
- 2 minute long video pitch of the final project, this can be uploaded to the preferred platform such as YouTube or Vimeo, but it has to be available for everyone to enjoy. And to be very frank: **not a second longer than 2 minutes**, and we will be very strict with this.
- Demo and source code links
- Source code publicity
- Do you want to be credited for the project?
- Pitch deck (pdf)
- Phone numbers of your team members (we will call you if you win something)
- Discord username for contacting purposes if you don't answer your phone

Every partner will determine judging criteria that will determines what they are looking for in a project. **Remember to check carefully the judging criteria of the challenge** your team is doing, to ensure a great possibility of winning a challenge or the whole event.

🗣️ Pitching

Reserve enough time to prepare the pitch. With a great pitch, you can get more votes for your project. 🚀

We got your back and here is the article on How to pitch your idea at a Hackathon**.**

- **NOTE: The top teams will be contacted regarding the pitching before the Closing Ceremony.**

Some practicalities

- The top 5 teams will pitch on stage, chosen by peer reviewing
- Please practice your pitch beforehand
  - There will be no time to separately practice the pitch after the review period has ended.
- Each team has exactly 3 min for their pitch
  - After the time is up, the mics will be killed to keep the competition fair
- After pitching, judges will have 3 minutes to ask questions from you.
- We will inform and come get the teams that will be pitching after the reviewing period has ended.
  - After this you will be taken to the streaming stage where you will pitch your project.
- There will be one hand held mic per team while pitching.
  - We advise that one person is on stage for the best audience experience, but we don't prohibit more people coming on stage
- You will have a chance to demo your project on the stage from your own computer.
  - We will check that you are able to connect your computer beforehand

💬 Communication Channels

There are two communication channels in use during the Junction weekend, so we figured to take this chance and explain it here as clearly as possible. Even though some of the information is overlapping between the platforms, each platform has its own purpose as a communications channel.

Junction Platform

Junction 2026 dashboard on Junction Platform is where the most important interactions between the team, participant and partners happens. This is where you have already applied for the event.

Your next steps after being accepted should be:

1. **Confirm or cancel your application.**
2. **Make a team or join existing one.**
3. **Fill information in your Junction Platform Profile if you are interested in recruitment.** Our Partner companies will be checking it out. We asked same questions in registrations, but they are not linked to the profile automatically, so make sure to do that AGAIN.

4. **One member from the team creates a project submission.**
5. **By Friday 23:59 submit a draft for a team count.**
6. **FINAL submission by Sunday 10:00.**

The check-in at the venue on Friday and submissions on Sunday will be handled through your dashboard. **So make sure to remember your login details.**

Discord

This year we are using Discord as the main discussion channel for all communication between partners, participants and the Junction team. You will stay up to date through the #announcements channel and can ask questions from organizers there.

Join Junction 2026 server here: Join the Junction Discord Server!

03 Speakers, Workshops, and Side Events

🎤 Speakers

TO BE UPDATED

🛠️ Workshops

Don’t miss the Junction 2026 Workshops!

Unlock new skills, meet mentors, and supercharge your project with hands-on sessions across AI, hardware, design, product, and more. Seats are limited, so grab your spot early and bring your teammates!

- Learn from top industry experts
- Get practical, project-ready skills
- Ask questions and get live feedback
- Discover tools and techniques to level up fast

No sign-up needed

Workshops are first come, first served – no sign-up required. Capacity is limited, so arrive a few minutes early to secure your seat!

How to get there

Workshops are held in the **Loft on the 4th floor** and in the **Hardware Lab on the 5th floor**. Check each workshop below for its location.

FRIDAY

FRI 20:00–20:30

Google DeepMind

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

FRI 20:30–21:00

Arduino

Description coming soon

- Location: **Arduino Hardware Lab, 5th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

FRI 20:30–21:00

Verda

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

FRI 21:00–21:30

MLH x GitHub

Description coming soon

- Location: To be announced
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SATURDAY

SAT 11:00–11:30

Cala: Tips & tricks to Make Unicorns Real

Cala's secret gathering: tips & tricks to Make Unicorns Real

Consider this your insider briefing for the Make Unicorns Real challenge, where you'll build a product that solves a real need for founders or VCs, powered by reliable public data from Cala.

We'll show you how to get the most out of Cala, the public data layer for AI agents. You'll learn how to query companies, people, investors and funding rounds, and how to use the connections between them to build things web search can't. We'll also share what our judges are looking for.

Already in, or still deciding? Either way, come find out what the other teams won't hear. The Cala team will be there to answer your questions, and stay around afterwards to help you shape your idea. And keep an eye out for Cala merch.

Host: Elies Delgado

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SAT 12:00–12:30

Intel

Description coming soon

- Location: **Hardware Lab, 5th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SAT 13:30–14:00

Modal

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SAT 14:30–15:15

Kiuas

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SAT 16:30–17:00

Exa

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SAT 17:30–18:00

Context

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

SAT 18:00–18:30

Maria01

Description coming soon

- Location: **Loft, 4th floor**
- Capacity is limited. Arrive early to secure a seat.
- Bring: laptop and your project context

04 Relax & Recharge

🛌 Accommodation

Hotel Discount

Hotel Matts is the official accommodation partner of Junction Hackathon! Hotel Matts is offering **20% off** the flexible daily rate on hotel rooms and on fully equipped, spacious apartments. Valid **11–17 November 2026**, subject to availability.

Your stay includes:

- A generous buffet breakfast
- One night of free parking (1 car per booking), subject to availability. Additional nights €17.

Book at https://www.kassiopeia.fi/hotel-matts/ with the code: **JUNCTION**

Bookings can be cancelled free of charge until 18:00 on the day of arrival.

Hotel Matts is located in Matinkylä, about a 10-minute metro ride from the Hackathon Venue in Hype Arena.

🛋️ Lounges

We have two different Lounges for Hackers:

- **Hacker Lounge** is located on the 6th floor
- Other **Hacker Lounge** is located in the Loft on the 4th floor

See the maps in the Venue Map section.

🧖 Sauna

Hackers have their own separate sauna on the **7th floor** during the weekend.

🍝 Food

> On Friday and Saturday food is served on 2nd Floor in Bistro Lilla Sten and 3rd floor. We encourage you to take the food with you to **your working spot.** Breakfast and Sunday lunch are served on a self-service basis at snack points.

Special diets available on the 2nd floor, on a separate line!

🚰 Helpful reminder: Tap water is safe to drink here in Finland

Friday Dinner at 19:30 – 22:00

TO BE UPDATED

(LF, GF & VEG option avail.)

Saturday Lunch at 11:00 – 13:30

TO BE UPDATED

(LF, GF & VEG option avail.)

Saturday Dinner at 19:30 – 22:00

TO BE UPDATED

(LF, GF & VEG option avail.)

Sunday Snack at 10:00 - 13:30

(LF, GF & VEG option avail.)

- VEG = Vegetarian
- VE = Vegan
- LF = Lactose-free
- GF = Gluten-free
- avail. = available

In the maps in the Venue Map section, you can identify the restaurant and snack points from the yellow color.



05 Rules to Follow

Security & First Aid

The security and first aid teams are here to help you throughout the whole event.

112 **Emergency number**
Police, fire & ambulance in Finland. Free to call from any phone, no area code needed.

Security/First Aid hotline at Junction:

> **+358 40 1640496 Casandra Julin, Security team lead**

The security and first aid teams are here to help you throughout the whole event. If you have any questions regarding safety and security or first aid, ask any one of us roaming the venue or call/text our hotline.

You can recognize us easily by the vests we wear:

- **Community service officers (security): Yellow high-visibility vests**
- **Community service officers (security) – supervisors: Orange high-visibility vests**

If you need first aid or any other kind of medical assistance, please come to the **first aid station located on the 3rd floor**. If you have any medication that requires refrigeration, we have a fridge available for this at the first aid station.

You are free to exit and enter the venue during the event, but only through the official entrances. Do not use the emergency exits unless there is a real emergency. The emergency exit doors have alarms that will trigger when opened.

Please remember that when entering and inside the venue, you must always have your badge visible. If given any instructions by the community service officers or other event staff, you must obey their instructions.

When to call the Junction security hotline:

- If you have a non-urgent matter or questions regarding security or first aid
- If you spot a fire that you were able to extinguish yourself
- Disturbances where no one is in danger: power outages etc.
- If you suspect a crime is happening
- If you or someone else is lost
- You've gotten sick and don't know where to go

Try to call the hotline first, EXCEPT if:

- Someone's life, health, property or the environment is threatened or in danger, or if you have reason to assume this to be the case

In these cases, call straight to the emergency number, and after that to the hotline so we know to guide the emergency services to the right place.

In Finland, we only use one emergency number, **112**. You can call the emergency number free of charge from any phone with no need for an area code. You can also call from a foreign mobile phone connection. You still won't need an area code, just dial 112.

We recommend downloading the "112 Suomi" app from your app store. The ERC operator automatically obtains your location when calling through the app. This way you speed up the emergency services and you don't need to know your exact location.

How to call 112:

1. Make the call yourself if you can
   - Call from a safe place
2. Explain what happened
3. Tell your exact address and municipality
   - Hybridiarena Hype, Vanha Jorvaksentie 3, 02320 Espoo
4. Answer all the ERC operator's questions
5. Follow the instructions given
6. Don't end the call until permitted to

What to do at the scene of an accident:

1. Find out what happened
2. Rescue anyone whose life is in danger
3. Move anyone injured to a safe place
4. Prevent further accidents
5. Warn others
6. Report the emergency to 112
7. Make sure that those injured are breathing and that their heart is beating
8. Stop any major bleeds
9. Continue to give first aid
10. Help the rescue workers find their way to the scene

🤝 Code of Conduct

> Junction stands for inclusivity. We believe that every single person has the right to participate in our events in a safe and welcoming environment.

Be respectful. Harassment and abuse are never tolerated in Junction events. If you are in a situation that makes you uncomfortable at any Junction event, if the event itself is creating an unsafe or inappropriate

environment, or if interacting with a Junction representative or event organizer makes you uncomfortable, please report it using the procedures included below.

Harassment includes but is not limited to:

- Disrespectful or offensive verbal or written comments related to gender, age, sexual orientation, disability, physical appearance, race, religion, social class or economic status
- Deliberate violent or intimidating behaviour, such as stalking, following, harassing photography or recording
- Inappropriate physical contact and unwelcome sexual attention

If what you're doing is making someone feel uncomfortable, that counts as harassment and is enough reason to stop doing it.

By attending a Junction event, you agree to obey these rules. Participants asked to stop any harassing behavior are expected to comply immediately. Sponsors, partners, mentors, volunteers, organizers, Junction staff, and anyone else at the event are also subject to the anti-harassment policy.

If an attendee engages in harassing behavior, Junction may take any action it deems appropriate, including issuing warning or expulsion from the event with no eligibility for reimbursement or refund of any type.

Junction representatives will be happy to help participants, provide escort, or otherwise help attendees feel safe for the duration of the event. We value your attendance. We expect all attendees to follow these rules at all event venues, as well as online interactions in relation to the event.

Reporting Procedures

If you feel uncomfortable or think there may be a potential violation of the code of conduct, please report it immediately using one of the following methods. All reporters have the right to remain anonymous.

- Finding someone having "Crew" -badge or security vests, they are trusted people from Junction
- Contacting harassment contact persons via phone or email
- If you don't get answers in the ways mentioned above or you need more support, don't hesitate to contact the management: Velma Linko (COO) +358 40 4622915, velma.linko@hackjunction.com

Harassment contact persons

Oula Karinen / Production Team Lead
oula@hackjunction.com
+358 44 3389744

Lotta Hämäläinen / Head of People
lotta@hackjunction.com
+358 44 2222095

Junction reserves the right to revise, make exceptions to, or otherwise amend these policies in whole or in part. If you have any questions regarding these policies, drop us a line at hello@hackjunction.com.

📜 Junction Rules

Here are the official rules for Junction 2026. To be eligible for prizes, including the **10 000 €** main prize (total prize pool **100 000 €**), you must follow these rules:

- No code written before the event.

- Allowed team size is 1 – 4.
- You must participate in at least one challenge.
- You and your team must take part in the live peer reviewing on Sunday to be eligible for the main prize.
- The project submission must contain a pitch video, maximum 2 minutes long.
- You must submit a link to your source. All code outside of open source libraries must be written at the event. If you use any code written specifically for this idea in advance, or work on a new project that is somehow related to an already existing company, you will be disqualified. All project submissions are licensed under the MIT open-source license, and organizers must be able to access your source code.

LEGAL

Who has ownership of the content created in Junction?

The work done by the participants is owned solely by the participants and their teams. Note that all project submissions are licensed under the MIT open-source license. However, a thing to acknowledge is that the partner APIs and other material used is subject to the partner terms. Please consult legal advisors in case you need help with more detailed questions.

How can I delete or modify my information after the event?

Information can be found in the Privacy Policy. You have accepted the Terms & Conditions and Privacy Policy when applying to Junction 2026.

Contact hello@hackjunction.com to ask questions about your personal data.

🌼 Safe Space Guardians

If you feel uncomfortable or think there may be a potential violation of the code of conduct, please report it immediately to the following people:

Safe Space Guardians will come on stage during the opening ceremony for you to see them in person. For recognition they will also be wearing a band on their hand throughout the event.

Contacts:

Oula Karinen / Production Team Lead
email: oula@hackjunction.com
phone number: +358 44 3389744

Lotta Hämäläinen / Head of People
email: lotta@hackjunction.com
phone number: +358 44 2222095



06 International Participants

Travel grants ✈️

Applications for the **300 €** and **100 €** international travel grants have **closed**. Unless you have received written confirmation of a travel grant, please plan to cover your own travel and accommodation costs.

Looking for a place to stay? Check the Accommodation section for the Junction hotel discount.

Need help? 💬

For up-to-date information, check the Junction 2026 event dashboard, the event website and the emails sent by Junction.

Didn't find an answer to your question? Reach out to us at **hello@hackjunction.com**